SELF-CARE

Self-Care Assessment & Planning Guide

Assess, plan, and protect your well-being across six dimensions

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> 💡 *Self-care isn't selfish. It's how you stay available for the people who need you.*

When you're running on empty, everyone around you feels it — your children, your partner, your colleagues. You can't pour from an empty cup, and you certainly can't show up as the parent, partner, or person you want to be when you're depleted.

This guide will help you honestly assess where you stand across six key dimensions of well-being, identify the areas that need the most attention, and build a realistic plan that fits your actual life — not someone else's idea of what self-care should look like.

Self-care doesn't have to mean spa days and weekend retreats. It can be five minutes of quiet before the house wakes up. It can be saying no to one thing this week. It can be going to bed thirty minutes earlier. What matters is that it's intentional, consistent, and yours.

Section 1: The 6-Dimension Self-Care Assessment

For each dimension below, read the reflection questions carefully, then rate yourself on a scale of **1 to 5**:

- **1** = I'm really struggling here
- **2** = I'm not doing well in this area
- **3** = I'm managing, but just barely
- **4** = I'm doing fairly well
- **5** = I feel strong and consistent here

Be honest. No one is reading this but you.

Dimension 1: Emotional Self-Care

Your ability to process, express, and sit with your feelings.

Reflect on these questions:

- Do I acknowledge my feelings, or do I push them down and keep going?

- When I'm overwhelmed, do I have someone I can talk to honestly?
- Am I able to say "I'm not okay" without feeling weak?
- Do I give myself permission to feel sad, angry, or frustrated without judgment?
- When was the last time I cried, laughed deeply, or let myself truly feel something?
- Do I ask for help when I need it, or do I wait until I'm in crisis?

My Emotional Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

What I notice about my emotional health right now:

_____

_____

Dimension 2: Physical Self-Care

How you treat your body — not for appearance, but for energy and well-being.

Reflect on these questions:

- Am I getting enough sleep? (7-9 hours, and is the quality good?)
- Do I move my body in ways that feel good — not punishing — most days?
- Am I eating in a way that nourishes me, or am I skipping meals and running on caffeine?
- When was my last medical or dental check-up?
- Do I listen when my body tells me to rest, or do I override those signals?
- Am I drinking enough water throughout the day?

My Physical Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

What my body has been trying to tell me:

_____

_____

Dimension 3: Social Self-Care

The quality of your relationships and your sense of belonging.

Reflect on these questions:

- Do I have at least one person I can be completely honest with?

- Am I spending time with people who energize me, or mostly with people who drain me?
- Have I set boundaries with relationships that consistently take more than they give?
- Do I feel lonely, even when I'm surrounded by people?
- Am I making time for friendships, or have I let them all fall away?
- Do I feel part of a community — however small?

My Social Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

The relationship that needs the most attention right now:

_____

_____

Dimension 4: Spiritual Self-Care

Your sense of purpose, meaning, and connection to something larger than yourself. This doesn't have to be religious — it's about what grounds you.

Reflect on these questions:

- Do I feel a sense of purpose in my daily life?
- Am I living in alignment with my core values, or am I drifting?
- Do I make time for practices that bring me peace — prayer, meditation, nature, reflection?
- When was the last time I felt truly present in a moment, not rushing to the next thing?
- Do I feel hopeful about the future, or has cynicism crept in?
- Am I spending time on things that matter to me, or only on things that are urgent?

My Spiritual Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

What gives my life the most meaning right now:

_____

_____

Dimension 5: Professional Self-Care

Your relationship with work, productivity, and the boundary between who you are and what you do.

Reflect on these questions:

- Can I leave work at work — mentally and physically — or does it follow me everywhere?
- Do I take my breaks, use my vacation days, and protect my time off?
- Am I experiencing signs of burnout: exhaustion, detachment, feeling ineffective?
- Do I feel valued and recognized in my work, or invisible?
- Have I set boundaries around emails, messages, and availability outside work hours?
- Is my workload sustainable, or am I always behind?

My Professional Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

The biggest work-related stressor in my life right now:

_____

_____

Dimension 6: Intellectual Self-Care

How you stimulate your mind, stay curious, and grow beyond your daily routine.

Reflect on these questions:

- When was the last time I learned something new — just because I was curious?
- Do I read, listen to podcasts, or engage with ideas that challenge my thinking?
- Am I in a mental rut, going through the same motions every day?
- Do I have creative outlets — writing, art, music, cooking, building?
- Am I engaging with the world beyond my immediate responsibilities?
- Do I feel mentally stimulated, or mentally numb?

My Intellectual Self-Care Score: _____ / 5

Something I've been wanting to learn or explore:

_____

_____

Section 2: Your Self-Care Score

Add up your scores from all six dimensions.

Dimension	Score
Emotional	_____ / 5
Physical	_____ / 5
Social	_____ / 5
Spiritual	_____ / 5
Professional	_____ / 5
Intellectual	_____ / 5
TOTAL	_____ **/ 30**

What Your Score Means

24-30: Thriving You're doing well. You've built habits and awareness that support your well-being across most areas of life. Keep it up — and pay attention to any dimension that scored below a 4. Even small dips, left unattended, can grow into bigger problems over time.

18-23: Steady but Stretched You're managing, but there are cracks forming. Some areas of your life are getting what they need; others are being neglected. This is the most common range — and the most important time to act. You're not in crisis, but you're heading toward burnout if you don't make intentional changes.

12-17: Needs Serious Attention You're running on fumes. Multiple areas of your life are underfed, and you're probably feeling the effects — exhaustion, irritability, disconnection, or a persistent sense that something is wrong. This score is a signal, not a sentence. It means it's time to ask for help and start making even small changes.

6-11: Burnout Risk You are depleted. This isn't about willpower or trying harder — it's about getting support. Please consider talking to a professional. You deserve care, and you don't have to figure this out alone. This score often comes with shame, but there's no shame in being honest about where you are. That honesty is the first step toward recovery.

Your Highest and Lowest Dimensions

My strongest dimension: _____ (Score: _____)

This is your anchor. When everything else feels hard, lean into what's already working.

My weakest dimension: _____ (Score: _____)

This is where to focus first. Even one small change here can shift everything.

My second weakest dimension: _____ (Score: _____)

Once you've addressed your weakest area, turn your attention here.

Section 3: Build Your Personal Self-Care Plan

For each dimension, choose **one specific action** you can commit to this month. Make it small enough to actually do. "Exercise more" isn't a plan. "Walk for 15 minutes on Tuesday and Thursday mornings" is.

My Self-Care Action Plan

Emotional Self-Care

- My one action: _____
- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

Physical Self-Care

- My one action: _____
- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

Social Self-Care

- My one action: _____
- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

Spiritual Self-Care

- My one action: _____
- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

Professional Self-Care

- My one action: _____

- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

Intellectual Self-Care

- My one action: _____
- When I'll do it: _____
- Who supports me in this: _____

My Self-Care Non-Negotiable

Every sustainable plan has one thing that's sacred — the thing you protect no matter what.

My non-negotiable self-care practice is:

_____

I commit to protecting this because:

_____

Section 4: The 7-Day Self-Care Starter Challenge

If your plan feels overwhelming, start here. One small action per day. Seven days. That's it.

Day 1: Body

Go to bed 30 minutes earlier than usual tonight. No screens in bed. Just rest.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 2: Connection

Send a message to someone you haven't talked to in a while. Not a meme — a real message. Tell them you were thinking of them.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 3: Stillness

Spend 5 minutes in complete silence. No phone, no music, no tasks. Just sit with yourself. Notice what comes up.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 4: Movement

Move your body for at least 15 minutes in a way that feels good — a walk, stretching, dancing in your kitchen. Not punishment. Pleasure.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 5: Boundaries

Say no to one thing today that you would normally say yes to out of obligation. Notice how it feels.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 6: Curiosity

Spend 20 minutes on something that interests you but isn't productive. Read an article, watch a documentary clip, sketch something, listen to a new album.

I did it: [ ] Yes [ ] Not yet **How it felt:** _____

Day 7: Reflection

Write a short letter to yourself. Start with: "This week, I learned that I need..."

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

End-of-Week Reflection

After completing the 7-day challenge:

The day that felt easiest was: _____

The day that felt hardest was: _____

What surprised me this week: _____

One thing I want to keep doing: _____

One thing I want to add next week: _____

A Note Before You Go

Self-care isn't a one-time exercise. It's a practice — something you return to again and again as your life changes. The person you were when you started this guide isn't the same person who will pick it up next month or next year. Your needs will shift. Your capacity will change. What stays the same is the commitment to showing up for yourself so you can show up for the people you love.

If this assessment revealed that you're struggling more than you realized, please know: that awareness is not failure. It's courage. And you don't have to carry it alone.

Mama Hala Consulting is here to support you. Whether you need individual counseling, family guidance, or simply a safe space to talk, Dr. Hala Ali offers bilingual (English/Arabic) sessions for individuals and families in Ottawa, Dubai, and online.

Book a free consultation: mamahala.ca **Email:** info@mamahala.ca

You've already taken the first step by being honest with yourself. The next step is asking for support.

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Ready for Personalized Support?

Your first conversation is free — 30 minutes, no pressure. Let's explore how counseling can help you and your family thrive.

Book Your Free Consultation

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